TEAM C29 · APPOINTMENT RECOVERY DESK · FYND × NMIMS HYDERABAD

Refill, explained simply

What problem we picked, what our app does about it, and a full day in a salon from start to finish. Written for the pitch: no technical terms.

When someone cancels an appointment, Refill fills that empty slot with the next person who wants it, has agreed to be contacted, and actually fits it. It never puts two people in the same slot, and it can always say why it chose who it chose.

1. The problem

Any business that runs on appointments (salons, clinics, spas, physiotherapists, tutors) loses money every time a client cancels at short notice. The chair or the room sits empty, the staff member is paid anyway, and the money for that hour is gone.

The slot goes to waste

A cancellation an hour or two before the appointment is rarely refilled. The front desk is busy and there is no quick way to find someone.

The front desk has to guess

They scroll through a list, call people one by one, and often offer the slot to someone who wants a different service or is not free then.

People get messages they never wanted

Messaging everyone on the list annoys clients who never agreed to it, and damages trust in the business.

Two people turn up for one slot

If two people say yes at the same moment, a manual system can book both. Someone gets turned away at the door.

2. Our idea

Keep a waiting list of clients who would happily come in at short notice. When a slot opens, Refill instantly shows who fits it, offers it only to people who said yes to messages, and the first one to accept gets it. Everyone else keeps their place in the queue.

Think of it as a smart waiting list attached to the appointment book. The business does not change how it books appointments; Refill takes over only at the moment something goes wrong: a cancellation, or a staff member calling in sick.

3. How it works, in five steps

1. **A client cancels**

   The front desk taps that appointment and records the cancellation. The slot turns amber on the screen: an open gap, with the money at stake shown next to it.

2. **Refill finds who fits**

   From the waiting list, it picks out people who want a service this staff member does, whose service fits in the time available, who are free then, and who said yes to messages. Everyone left out has a one-line reason.

3. **The front desk sends offers**

   With one tap, an offer goes to the best few people. Each offer is held for 15 minutes, and no one gets more than 3 messages a day.

4. **First to accept gets the slot**

   The client taps "Book" on their phone. If two people tap at the same moment, exactly one gets it; the other is told politely and keeps their place in the queue.

5. **The slot turns green**

   The empty slot is filled, the money is recovered, and every step is written down so the owner can see exactly what happened.

4. Who uses Refill

Each person gets their own view and sees only what they need. Each person's link is private, so no one can see or change anything that is not theirs.

WHO	WHAT THEY SEE	WHAT THEY CAN DO
Front desk	"What needs you now": open slots, clients who need moving. Who is in today. The day's schedule. The waiting list.	Record cancellations, offer open slots, move an appointment to another time, send a client a link to choose, mark a staff member as out.
Owner	Money recovered today, money still at risk, how offers went, who agreed to messages, how busy each staff member is.	Set the rules (how long an offer is held, how many messages a day, what counts as a late cancellation). Create links for staff and the front desk.
Staff member	Only their own day, with clients' first names.	Tap "I can't come in today". The front desk sees it straight away.

Client	Their place in the queue, their booking, any offer they received.	Join the waiting list (and choose yes or no to messages), book or decline an offer, pick a new time if their appointment has to move, or cancel.

5. A day at Kesar Salon (the demo scenario)

Kesar Salon in Jubilee Hills has four staff: Riya (hair and skin), Arjun (hair), Meher (nails and skin) and Kabir (hair and nails). It is 11:15 on a busy day. Fourteen people are on the waiting list.

1. **11:15 · A cancellation**

   Ananya cancels her 2:30 hair spa with Riya. On the front desk's screen, 2:30 turns `amber`: an open slot worth ₹1,500.

2. **Who fits?**

   The receptionist taps the slot. Refill shows four people who fit: Meera (wants exactly a hair spa), Zoya, Rhea and Omar, all of whom said yes to messages. It also shows who was left out, and why:

   3. Arnav has never been asked about messages, so he is **not contacted**.
   4. Nisha said no to messages, so she is **not contacted**.
   5. Leela needs 90 minutes; the slot is only 60.
   6. Sameer wants a nail service; Riya does not do nails.
   7. Kiran is only free in the evening.

8. **Offers go out**

   The receptionist taps "Send 3 offers". Meera, Zoya and Rhea each get a message: "A 2:30 slot just opened. Tap to book. Held for you until 11:30."

9. **Two people tap at once**

   Meera and Zoya both tap "Book" at the same second. Meera gets it. Zoya sees "Someone got there a moment before you. You keep your place in the queue." There is no double booking and no awkward phone call.

10. **The money comes back**

    2:30 turns `green`. The owner's page now shows ₹1,500 recovered today.

11 **12:00 · A staff member calls in sick**

Riya can't come in. The receptionist marks her as out. Her clients turn `red` under "Needs you now". Nothing is moved automatically; people choose.

12 **Rebooking her clients**

Pooja (1:30 facial) is on the phone, so the receptionist taps "Pick a new time". Refill shows only times that really work: Meher does facials and is free at 1:30. One tap moves her. For Varun (4:00 haircut), the receptionist taps "Let Varun choose". Varun gets a link, sees the free times with Arjun or Kabir, and picks the one he likes.

13 **Nothing slips through**

The time Pooja and Varun left behind is held, not offered, because Riya is not there. Refill never books anyone with a staff member who is out or has gone home for the day.

6. Features at a glance

Filling cancelled slots

- Shows instantly who fits an open slot
- Explains in one line why anyone was left out
- Offers held for 15 minutes, then passed to the next people
- First to accept gets it; the rest keep their place
- Late cancellations are flagged
- Undo a cancellation recorded by mistake

Respecting clients

- Nobody is messaged without saying yes first
- Clients join the waiting list themselves by scanning a code at the counter
- Nothing is pre-ticked; they choose yes or no
- At most 3 messages a day; reply STOP to end them all
- Clients can leave the waiting list any time

Rescheduling (added after MBA feedback)

- Move any appointment to another time in two taps
- Or send the client a link to choose a time themselves
- Only times that really work are shown
- The time they leave opens up for the waiting list

Running the team

- Mark a staff member out with one tap
- Their clients are flagged straight away
- Working hours respected: nobody is booked with someone who has gone home
- Each person has their own private view

For the owner

- Money recovered today, and money still at risk
- How many offers were accepted, declined or ignored
- How busy each staff member is
- The owner sets the rules; the front desk cannot change them

Trust and record-keeping

- Every action is written down in plain sentences
- The record cannot be edited afterwards
- It can be downloaded as a spreadsheet
- Works on any phone or computer, and can be installed like an app

7. Each problem, and how Refill solves it

PROBLEM	HOW REFILL SOLVES IT
Cancelled slots go empty and the money is lost	Offers the slot to the right people within seconds and shows the money recovered.
The front desk guesses and calls people one by one	Shows exactly who fits, in order, with one tap to send offers.
The slot is offered to someone it doesn't suit	Checks the service, the time it needs, when the client is free, and whether the staff member does that service.
Clients get messages they never asked for	Only people who said yes are ever contacted, at most 3 times a day.
Two people are booked into one slot	Only one booking per slot is ever possible, even if people accept at the same moment.
A staff member calls in sick	Their clients are flagged at once and moved to someone free, or choose a new time themselves.
Nobody knows what happened or why	Every decision has a plain reason and a permanent record.

8. Our three promises

Never two in one slot
One slot, one booking. Always.

Never without permission
No yes, no message.

Always a reason
Every choice can be explained in one sentence.

9. Not just salons

We used a salon because the case asked for one, but nothing in Refill is specific to salons. The same idea works for any business that runs on appointments and loses money on cancellations: clinics and dentists, physiotherapy, spas, tutoring, car servicing, fitness classes. Only the list of services and staff changes.

10. Help for the pitch

One line

Refill turns last-minute cancellations back into paid appointments, without bothering anyone who didn't ask to be contacted.

Thirty seconds

Every appointment business loses money when clients cancel at short notice: the slot stays empty and the staff are paid anyway. Refill keeps a waiting list of people who would happily come in at short notice. When a slot opens, it shows who fits, offers it only to those who agreed to be messaged, and the first to accept gets it. Nobody is ever double-booked, and every decision comes with a reason. If a staff member calls in sick, their clients are rebooked in a couple of taps, or pick a new time themselves.

Questions judges may ask, with simple answers

QUESTION	ANSWER
What if two people accept at the same time?	Only one gets the slot. The other is told straight away and keeps their place in the queue. We tested this with eight people tapping at once: exactly one booking every time.
Why would a client agree to be messaged?	They choose to join because they want an earlier slot. They control it: at most 3 messages a day, and STOP ends them all.
What if someone needs a longer service than the free slot?	They are not offered it. Refill shows "needs more time" next to their name.
What did you change after the business team's feedback?	Rescheduling: the desk can move an appointment, or send the client a link to pick a new time, instead of only cancelling.
Does the business have to change how it works?	No. It keeps its usual booking; Refill steps in only when something goes wrong.
Who sees clients' details?	Only the owner and the front desk. Staff see first names for their own day. Clients see only their own booking.

11. Try it yourself

Open **fillthechair.vercel.app** on a phone or a laptop. The home screen shows the whole day at a glance. Tap **Front desk** to run the day, **Owner** for the numbers, a staff member's name for their view, or **Client** to join the waiting list yourself. All the data is made up for the demo, and no real messages are ever sent.
